

ELITE SAGARIN MODEL

FBS & FCS Power Ratings — 2026 Preseason

Sources: Jeff Sagarin Final 2025 ratings (through CFP Championship Jan 19 2026) + Bill Connelly SP+ Preseason 2026 (ESPN). Composite = 70% SP+_scaled + 30% Sagarin. SP+_scaled = 71.0 + 0.90 × SP+. Home advantage = 2.80 pts (SP+ calibrated vs market).

FBS — Top 60 Power Ratings (2026 Preseason Composite)

Composite incorporates returning production, coaching changes, recruiting, and portal activity via SP+. ★ = major coaching change / roster reset.

Rank	Team	Conf	SP+ '26	SP+↑↓	Sagarin '25	Composite	Change Flag
1	Ohio State	Big Ten	+31.8	+31.8	95.16	98.3	
2	Oregon	Big Ten	+28.3	+28.3	94.27	95.8	
3	Indiana	Big Ten	+24.5	+24.5	100.06	95.2	
4	Notre Dame	Big Ten	+25.8	+25.8	94.60	94.3	
5	Texas Tech	Big 12	+23.1	+23.1	90.88	91.5	
6	Texas	SEC	+23.7	+23.7	86.35	90.5	
7	Miami	ACC	+21.0	+21.0	93.02	90.8	
8	Texas A&M;	SEC	+20.3	+20.3	85.87	88.2	
9	LSU	SEC	+20.2	+20.2	79.14	87.2	★ Lane Kiffin +9.7 SP+ bump; huge por
10	Alabama	SEC	+18.2	+18.2	85.61	86.8	
11	Ole Miss	SEC	+15.9	+15.9	88.84	86.4	
12	Oklahoma	SEC	+17.2	+17.2	83.67	85.6	
13	USC	Big Ten	+16.8	+16.8	83.43	85.3	
14	Penn State	Big Ten	+15.7	+15.7	86.46	85.5	
15	Michigan	Big Ten	+16.1	+16.1	80.89	84.1	
16	Tennessee	SEC	+16.0	+16.0	80.32	83.9	
17	BYU	Big 12	+15.5	+15.5	81.85	84.0	
18	Washington	Big Ten	+14.5	+14.5	85.20	84.4	
19	Iowa	Big Ten	+13.6	+13.6	86.07	84.1	
20	Missouri	SEC	+14.8	+14.8	80.49	83.2	
21	Florida	SEC	+14.9	+14.9	76.94	82.9	★ Jon Sumrall new HC +11.2 SP+ bump
22	Utah	Big 12	+11.9	+11.9	86.80	83.2	
23	Clemson	ACC	+12.8	+12.8	79.32	81.6	
24	SMU	ACC	+10.9	+10.9	83.00	81.5	
25	Vanderbilt	SEC	+10.0	+10.0	85.49	81.6	
26	S Carolina	SEC	+12.1	+12.1	77.59	80.6	
27	Louisville	ACC	+11.0	+11.0	79.95	80.6	
28	Auburn	SEC	+11.2	+11.2	79.03	80.5	
29	Arizona	Big 12	+10.2	+10.2	78.60	79.7	
30	Kansas State	Big 12	+10.4	+10.4	76.06	79.1	
31	Illinois	Big Ten	+9.3	+9.3	79.28	79.3	

Rank	Team	Conf	SP+ '26	SP+↑↓	Sagarin '25	Composite	Change Flag
32	TCU	Big 12	+9.1	+9.1	77.31	78.6	
33	Florida State	ACC	+8.8	+8.8	75.80	78.0	
34	Houston	Big 12	+8.2	+8.2	74.43	77.2	
35	Virginia	ACC	+6.6	+6.6	78.95	77.5	
36	Virginia Tech	ACC	+9.4	+9.4	68.05	77.2	★ James Franklin + Penn State transfe
37	Pittsburgh	ACC	+6.5	+6.5	77.68	77.1	
38	Nebraska	Big Ten	+7.7	+7.7	73.22	76.5	
39	Ga. Tech	ACC	+6.0	+6.0	76.82	76.5	
40	Georgia Tech	ACC	+6.0	+6.0	76.82	76.5	
41	Arizona St.	Big 12	+6.4	+6.4	75.33	76.3	
42	Duke	ACC	+5.7	+5.7	76.71	76.3	
43	Boise State	Mtn West	+6.8	+6.8	72.26	75.7	
44	NC State	ACC	+4.9	+4.9	78.11	76.2	
45	Minnesota	Big Ten	+5.2	+5.2	73.35	75.0	
46	Arkansas	SEC	+5.0	+5.0	72.40	74.6	
47	Northwestern	Big Ten	+4.6	+4.6	72.98	74.5	
48	Wake Forest	ACC	+3.6	+3.6	73.91	74.1	
49	UCLA	Big Ten	+5.1	+5.1	67.71	74.0	★ Bob Chesney (from JMU) +13.6 SP+ bo
50	Baylor	Big 12	+4.5	+4.5	69.76	73.5	
51	Kentucky	SEC	+3.8	+3.8	72.64	73.9	
52	Cincinnati	Big 12	+4.5	+4.5	70.10	73.6	
53	Oklahoma St.	Big 12	+7.1	+7.1	58.25	73.6	★ Eric Morris + #1 NTX offense arrive
54	Kansas	Big 12	+3.7	+3.7	70.84	73.3	
55	Iowa State	Big 12	+1.0	+1.0	76.11	73.2	
56	Miss. State	SEC	+3.9	+3.9	69.95	73.1	
57	Wisconsin	Big Ten	+1.8	+1.8	73.99	73.0	
58	N. Carolina	ACC	+3.8	+3.8	65.57	72.6	★ Belichick hires Petrino as OC +10.2
59	California	ACC	+3.7	+3.7	67.89	72.4	
60	Rutgers	Big Ten	+1.8	+1.8	71.80	72.4	

FCS — Top 25 Power Ratings (2026 Preseason)

FCS composite based on Sagarin 2025 + preseason FCS polls (Craig Haley / Opta, NCAA.com). NDSU has moved to FBS (ranked 72nd) and is excluded. ★ = defending champion.

FCS Rank	Team	Conf	Sagarin '25	Comp. '26	2025 W	2025 L	Notes
1	★ Montana State	Big Sky	74.42	75.5	22	2	2025 Champions; #1 FCS preseason
2	Montana	Big Sky	68.36	69.0	13	2	#2 FCS preseason; Gillman returns at QB
3	Tarleton State	WAC	66.62	67.5	12	2	#8 FCS preseason; upset Army in 2025
4	Illinois State	MVFC	65.99	66.0	12	5	2025 runner-up; strong MVFC core
5	North Dakota	MVFC	63.67	64.0	8	6	MVFC depth

FCS Rank	Team	Conf	Sagarin '25	Comp. '26	2025 W	2025 L	Notes
6	S Dakota State	MVFC	62.08	63.0	9	5	Perennial contender; portal-heavy
7	Stephen F. Austin	Southland	61.99	62.0	11	3	Strong Southland program
8	Villanova	CAA	61.47	62.0	12	3	CAA top team; 12-3 in 2025
9	UC Davis	Big Sky	60.37	61.0	9	4	Big Sky power
10	Southern Illinois	MVFC	60.35	61.5	7	5	#12 FCS preseason; MVFC depth
11	South Dakota	MVFC	60.33	60.5	10	5	10-5 in 2025
12	Yale	Ivy	59.17	59.5	9	3	9-3 Ivy champ
13	Lehigh	Patriot	59.01	59.5	12	1	12-1 Patriot
14	Youngstown State	MVFC	58.81	59.0	8	5	MVFC
15	Abilene Christian	WAC	58.34	58.5	9	5	
16	Rhode Island	CAA	54.35	55.5	11	3	#6 FCS preseason; huge improvement
17	Sacramento State	Big Sky	56.88	57.0	7	5	New FBS in 2026 (note)
18	Idaho State	Big Sky	55.76	56.0	6	6	
19	SE Louisiana	Southland	55.85	56.0	9	4	
20	Austin Peay	WAC	55.00	55.5	7	5	
21	Monmouth	CAA	52.26	53.0	9	3	9-3 regular season 2025
22	Northern Arizona	Big Sky	52.67	53.0	7	5	
23	West Georgia	WAC	51.23	53.0	8	3	8-3 in 2025; #23 preseason
24	Western Carolina	SoCon	51.53	52.0	7	5	
25	ETSU	SoCon	50.83	51.5	7	5	